

1. GAME OVERVIEW

GOAL

Build the most influential city-state by developing an empire, managing citizens and military, and defeating Titans.

2-4 players | 90 min | Medium weight

After six rounds, score tribe-banner sets and card abilities. Highest total VP wins.

2. SETUP CHRONOLOGY

- A** Sort cards: Titan (1/2/3-star), Military, District, Empire A/B/C, and Starting.
- B** Place coin, knowledge, ambrosia, and extra citizen tokens beside the board; round marker starts before A.
- C** Shuffle Districts; reveal the top card. Shuffle each Titan deck; reveal each top card.
- D** Place 1 ambrosia on Learn, Rebuild, and Expand. Cover Explore and Grow.
- E** Shuffle Military; reveal cards equal to player count.
- F** Shuffle Empire A; reveal 4/5/6 cards for 2/3/4 players. Set Empire B aside; Empire C is a face-up searchable pile.
- G** Each player: board, matching starting Titan, Fishing Dock, Wheat Fields, City Guard, Militia, 6 coins, citizens 1/2/3; capacity 4 and income 5.
- H** Choose first player. Player 2 gains 1 coin; players 3-4 gain 2 coins. New players use the basic board side.

3. STRUCTURE OF A ROUND

1 PREPARE

Advance round marker; apply the round icon. Refresh Empire and Military rows. From round 2, players without a threatening Titan draw from the bottom of the required Titan deck.

2 PLAYER ACTIONS

Clockwise, take one action per turn until everyone passes: place a citizen, attack one Titan, build one stored Empire card, or pass.

3 END OF ROUND

Gain income. Resolve threatening Titan attacks. Slide coins from each used Military card name to its art. Return citizens; pass first-player token left.

ROUND MILESTONES

- R1: Empire A
- R2: reveal Explore
- R3: reveal Grow
- R4: switch to Empire B
- R6: final round

4. TYPICAL TABLE SETUP



Supplied setup photo - central board, markets, resources, and player areas

1. TURN OPTIONS

- Place Citizen: resolve the action immediately. If a higher-skill citizen is already there, pay 1 coin. Collect ambrosia on that action.
- Attack Titan: attack one face-up deck Titan or any threatening Titan. Use unused Military cards; each costs 1 plus coins already on it. Meet the shown defense, take the card, then roll 1 damage die per banner.
- Build Stored: pay the stored card cost and place it in your Empire row, respecting capacity.
- Pass: take no more turns this round. Other players continue until all pass.

2. KEY RULES & LIMITS

- Board spaces can hold multiple citizens. A lower-skill citizen may not enter beneath a higher-skill citizen without paying the 1-coin surcharge.
- Empire-card actions are normally usable once per round and by their owner only.
- Military cards used in an attack cannot be used again that round. Their future activation cost rises as coins accumulate.
- A threatening Titan can remain on a player board until defeated; unresolved Titans attack at round end.
- Food supports citizens. Capacity limits the total capacity cost of Empire cards. Army limit restricts active Military cards.
- Ambrosia boosts eligible actions and abilities; spend only where the related ability permits.

3. SCORING SUMMARY

DURING THE GAME

- Build Empire cards to gain banners, income, food, capacity, citizens, and abilities.
- Defeat Titans for tribe banners and card benefits.
- Districts and specific cards may add VP or alter scoring.

FINAL SCORING

- Score each tribe-banner set using the banner scoring chart on the player aid or score pad.
- Add VP from Districts, Titans, Empire cards, and other end-game abilities.
- Apply all printed bonuses and penalties exactly as written.

Reminder: repeated banners build stronger sets; diversify only when card effects or availability justify it.

4. OFTEN FORGOTTEN

- Rounds 2 and 3 unlock Explore and Grow; Round 4 switches to Empire B.
- Threatening Titans are drawn from the bottom of the specified deck.
- Attacking another player's threatening Titan can award ambrosia, limited by that Titan's banners.
- Military-card attack access lasts for that attack only.
- Return citizens and pass the first-player token at end of round.

5. STRATEGIC TIPS

GOOD HABITS

- Plan income and food before adding citizens.
- Keep capacity and army-limit upgrades aligned with expansion.
- Use low-skill citizens early where competition is likely.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Forgetting the citizen skill surcharge.
- Reusing a Military card in the same round.
- Ignoring a threatening Titan until its attack becomes costly.

COMPETITIVE TIPS

- Watch banner concentration, not just card value.
- Attack another player's Titan when ambrosia and banners improve tempo.
- Time stored cards so building does not block a stronger citizen turn.
- Preserve coins for rising Military activation costs.

6. END OF GAME

- The game ends after Round 6.
- Resolve required final effects, then total VP.
- Score banner sets and all printed card or District VP.
- Highest VP wins; use the official tie procedure if tied.